

WF

2026 • ISSUE 01

WILEY FOX TRAVEL
FAMILIES AND SOLO TRAVELLERS

THE WILEY FOX GUIDE TO

London

For families & solo travellers

WILEY FOX RATING • MODERATE

3

OUT OF 5 • POLICE DATA MAY 2026 TO JUL 2026

CREATOR FEELING 4/5 • RELAXED, WITH BIG-CITY AWARENESS

£8.90

DAILY TUBE CAP, ZONES 1-2

Contactless or phone. Caps are frozen until March 2027 (TfL).

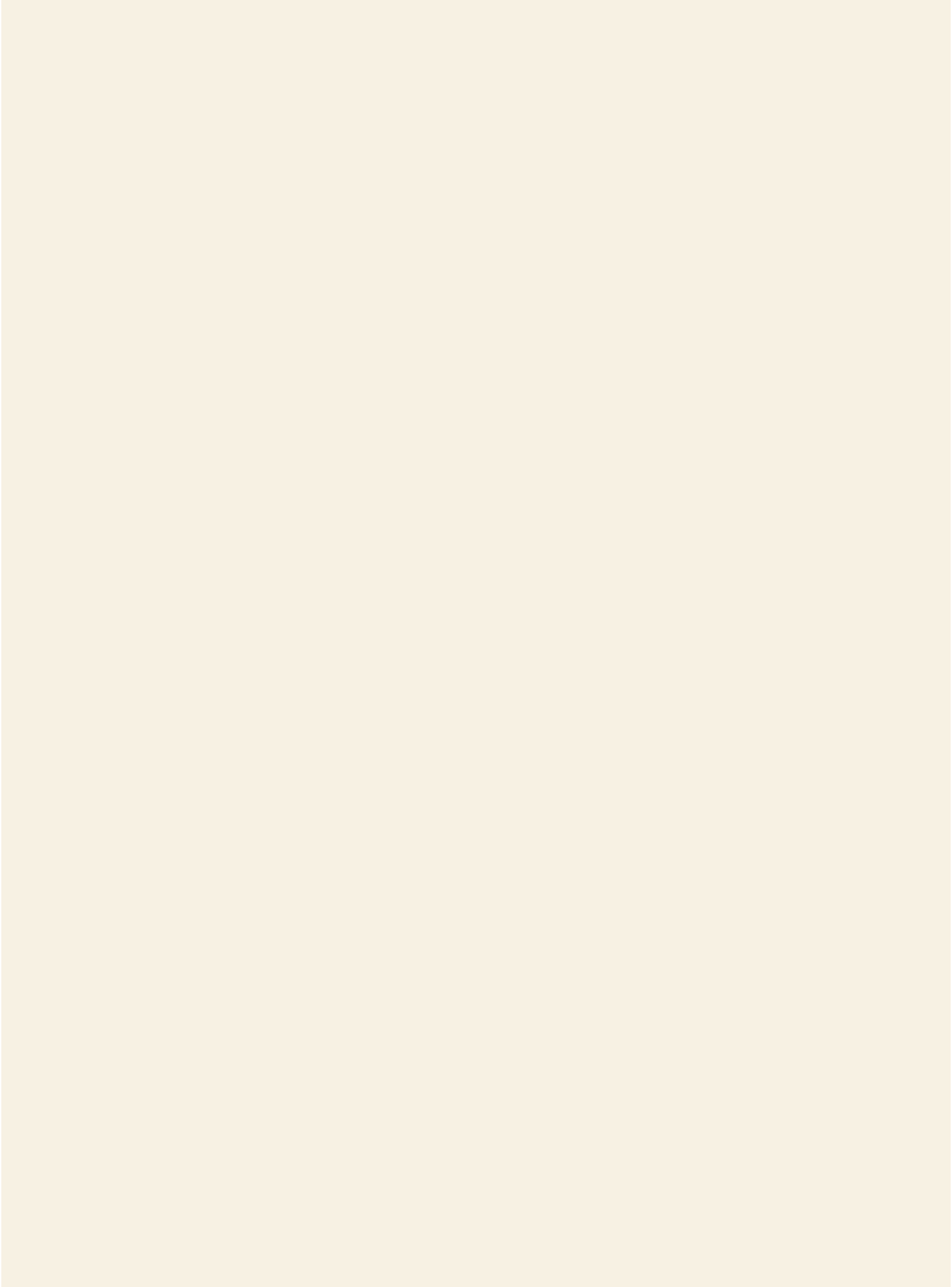
4,600

CRIMES A MONTH NEAR COVENT GARDEN

Almost half are thefts - bag and phone awareness matters most here.

13

CREATORS • 27 VIDEOS & POSTS



London is huge – more a region than a city – so the single best decision you make is where you stay. Creators agree on one rule above all others: book within a ten-minute walk of a Tube station, and group each day by neighbourhood rather than criss-crossing town.

For families it is one of the easiest capitals in the world. The big museums are free, the parks are enormous, and the Tube, buses and river boats reach almost everything. Children under 11 travel free on the Tube and buses with a paying adult.

For solo travellers it is lively every night of the week. The risks are ordinary big-city ones, and they cluster in predictable places. This guide shows you where, using the same police data that powers the Wiley Fox map.

WF

Check any hotel street on the Wiley Fox map before you book – tap it for the latest month of recorded crime nearby.

Fast facts

CURRENCY

Pound sterling (GBP) – almost everywhere is contactless

LANGUAGE

English

TIME ZONE

GMT / BST (UTC+1 in summer)

PLUG

Type G (three square pins)

EMERGENCY

999 • non-emergency police 101

ENTRY

Many visitors now need a UK ETA – £20 since April 2026

TIPPING

12.5% service is usually already on the bill

BEST TIME

May, or September to October

WHAT THE DATA AND THE CREATORS SAY

*How it feels, and what the numbers show**The data*

London is a well-policed city and most visits pass without trouble. The main risk for visitors is theft: pickpocketing and phone snatching in the busiest central areas. Violence against tourists is rare and concentrated late at night around nightlife and some outer town centres.

The creators

Every creator we reviewed describes London as comfortable for visitors, including families. The repeated warnings are practical ones: watch your phone near the kerb, keep bags zipped in crowds, never leave a phone on a pub table, and look right before you cross.

The Wiley Fox crime map of London

Every recorded street crime in Jul 2026, weighted by seriousness the same way as the Wiley Fox app and grouped into 350-metre hexagons. Colours compare each hexagon with the rest of London: red marks the busiest 5% of the city. Blank areas had no recorded crime. Busy, well-policed places like the West End show up red because so many people pass through them. For a street-level score, open the Wiley Fox map.





OpenFreeMap © OpenMapTiles Data from OpenStreetMap

Recorded crime vs rest of London

Highest 5% Next 10% Next 20% Middle 30% Lowest 35%

64,789 crimes · data.police.uk · [Check any street live on the Wiley Fox map](#)

Recorded crime by area

Recorded crimes are the monthly average for May to July 2026 within roughly one mile of each area centre (data.police.uk). Busy tourist areas record more crime partly because far more people pass through them; the circles for Soho, Covent Garden, Leicester Square and Oxford Street overlap.





Lowest Lower Moderate High Highest

Areas to take extra care

None of these are no-go areas. Know the pattern, and plan your timing and your route home.

● Leicester Square, Soho, Covent Garden & Oxford Street

TAKE MOST CARE: ALL DAY, BUSIEST EVENINGS AND WEEKENDS

The highest recorded crime in our sample, and nearly half of it is theft. Phone snatching by riders on e-bikes is the number-one warning from creators. Pedicab (rickshaw) drivers are unregulated - agree the price before you get in, or better, don't.

4,587 crimes a month nearby · top: other theft, theft from the person, violent crime

Via [Love and London](#), [Evan Edinger](#), [Wolters World](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Suitcase Monkey](#)

● Westminster Bridge & the South Bank by the London Eye

TAKE MOST CARE: DAYTIME CROWDS

Prime pickpocket territory and the spot for the shell-and-cup street game. You will never win it - the 'winners' are part of the act.

3,266 crimes a month nearby · top: theft from the person, other theft, violent crime

Via [Love and London](#), [Wolters World](#)

● Whitechapel

TAKE MOST CARE: LATE EVENING, AROUND THE STATION AND MAIN ROAD

Brick Lane and the markets are worth a daytime visit. Recorded crime is lower than the West End, but violence and anti-social behaviour make up a larger share. Some creators suggest it as a budget base; with children or a late arrival, we'd stay further west.

2,435 crimes a month nearby · top: violent crime, anti social behaviour, shoplifting

Via [The Tour Guy](#), [Love and London](#)

● Croydon town centre

TAKE MOST CARE: EVENINGS, AROUND WEST CROYDON

Violence is the top recorded category here. Cheap 'central London' hotel deals are often in Croydon - a long commute and not where we'd base a family trip.

1,354 crimes a month nearby · top: violent crime, anti social behaviour, shoplifting

Via [Destination Well Known](#)

● Lewisham town centre

TAKE MOST CARE: EVENINGS

Not a visitor area. A third of recorded crime is violence or robbery, the highest share in our sample. There's no reason to base a trip here.

1,104 crimes a month nearby · top: violent crime, anti social behaviour, shoplifting

Wiley Fox data

● Camden Market

TAKE MOST CARE: WEEKENDS AND SUMMER CROWDS

Very crowded at weekends, with theft and anti-social behaviour on the high street. For independent shops without the crush, locals point to Camden Passage by Angel instead.

1,644 crimes a month nearby · top: violent crime, anti social behaviour, theft from the person

Via [Love and London](#), [Camden David](#)

WF

Heading back late? Use Safest Route on thewileyfox.com to pick a better-lit, lower-crime walk to your hotel, and keep SOS one tap away.

Scams and tricks creators keep seeing

Phone snatching

Riders on e-bikes grab phones from people walking near the kerb. Step into a shop doorway to check maps, and keep your phone on the building side.

Via [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Happy to Wander](#), [Destination Well Known](#), [Suitcase Monkey](#), [Dutch Travel Maniac](#)

Pub table theft

Phones and wallets left on tables vanish in seconds. Keep bags in front of you or under the table, never on the back of your chair.

Via [Wolters World](#), [Happy to Wander](#)

Pedicab overcharging

Rickshaws in the West End have charged tourists hundreds of pounds for short rides. There is no regulated fare.

Via [Evan Edinger](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#)

Street games & 'free' gifts

The shell game, a 'found' ring or a free bracelet always ends with someone wanting money.

Via [Wolters World](#), [Love and London](#)

Fake petitions & charity collectors

Clipboard petitions around the sights are often a set-up for a donation or a distraction. A polite 'no thanks' and keep walking.

Via [Wolters World](#)

Currency conversion at ATMs and card machines

Always choose to pay in pounds. Letting the machine convert to your home currency can cost far more.

Via [Wolters World](#), [Love and London](#)

Unofficial theatre tickets

Buy from the theatre box office, TodayTix or the official TKTS booth in Leicester Square - not from people on the street.

Via [Wolters World](#), [Happy to Wander](#)

NEIGHBOURHOODS

Where to stay

Pick an area first, then a hotel. Every area card shows the latest recorded crime within about a mile, so you can compare busy against calm.

Photo: Diego Delso · [CC BY-SA 4.0](#)*South Kensington*

LOWER RECORDED CRIME

FAMILIES

Walk to the Natural History Museum, Science Museum and V&A - all free. Leafy, residential and well connected on three Tube lines.

1,166 crimes a month nearby · 23% theft · 21% violence or robbery

Via [Happy to Wander](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#)

Photo: Diliff · [CC BY-SA 2.5](#)Photo: Diego Delso · [CC BY-SA 4.0](#)*Kensington (High Street)*

LOWER RECORDED CRIME

FAMILIES

Next to Kensington Gardens and the Diana Memorial Playground. Calmer than the West End, still zone 1.

1,123 crimes a month nearby · 22% theft · 21% violence or robbery

Via [The Tour Guy](#)

Photo: DiscoA340 · [CC BY-SA 4.0](#)*Marylebone*

HIGHEST RECORDED CRIME

Westminster & South Bank

HIGH RECORDED CRIME

FAMILIES · FIRST-TIMERS

Big Ben, the London Eye and the river walk to Tower Bridge on foot. Busy by day, so recorded theft is high - keep bags zipped on Westminster Bridge.

3,266 crimes a month nearby · 40% theft · 22% violence or robbery

Via [Suitcase Monkey](#), [Love and London](#)

FAMILIES · SOLO

Village feel on Marylebone High Street, minutes from Oxford Street without its crowds. The data circle includes Oxford Street, which inflates the count.

4,019 crimes a month nearby · 39% theft · 17% violence or robbery

Via [Love and London](#)

Photo: Jakub Hatun · [CC BY 4.0](#)

Greenwich

LOWER RECORDED CRIME

FAMILIES

Royal Observatory, a free view over the whole city and a riverboat commute into town.

780 crimes a month nearby · 13% theft · 31% violence or robbery

Via [TOPJAW](#), [Destination Well Known](#)

Photo: Diliff · [CC BY-SA 3.0](#)

Richmond or Wimbledon

LOWEST RECORDED CRIME

FAMILIES · CALM BASE

The lowest recorded crime of every area we checked. Richmond has the river and Petersham Meadows; both are 20-45 minutes from central London by train.

292 crimes a month nearby · 12% theft · 28% violence or robbery

Via [Camden David](#)

Photo: mattbuck (category) · [CC BY-SA 4.0](#)

King's Cross

HIGH RECORDED CRIME

SOLO · RAIL TRAVELLERS

London's best-connected hub, with six Tube lines and Eurostar. Busy around the station at night; the canal-side Granary Square area is calmer.

2,786 crimes a month nearby · 31% theft · 22% violence or robbery

Via [Love and London](#)

Photo: Jeremy Keith from Brighton & Hove, United Kingdom · [CC BY 2.0](#)

Borough & London Bridge

MODERATE RECORDED CRIME

SOLO

Borough Market, riverside pubs and quick links everywhere. Bermondsey next door has a quieter, village feel.

2,368 crimes a month nearby · 38% theft · 21% violence or robbery

Via [Love and London](#), [Destination Well Known](#)

Photo: Marathon · [CC BY-SA 2.0](#)

Shoreditch

MODERATE RECORDED CRIME

SOLO

Street art, food and nightlife. Great for a younger solo trip - plan your late-night route home.

2,493 crimes a month nearby · 22% theft · 24% violence or robbery

Via [Love and London](#)

Hotels we'd start with

Wiley Fox may earn a small commission if you book through these links. Your price stays the same.

VICTORIA • FAMILIES

The Rubens at the Palace

Opposite the Royal Mews, walking distance to Buckingham Palace and St James's Park.

££££ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Wiley Fox pick

SOUTH BANK • FAMILIES

Park Plaza County Hall

Family rooms beside the London Eye and the river path.

£££ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Wiley Fox pick

SOUTH KENSINGTON • FAMILIES

The Ampersand Hotel

A short walk to three free museums in the calmest of the central areas we checked.

££££ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Wiley Fox pick

WESTMINSTER • FAMILIES & SOLO

St James' Court, A Taj Hotel

Quiet courtyard hotel near Buckingham Palace - used as a base by Curly Tales.

£££ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [Curly Tales](#)

HOLBORN • SOLO

The Hoxton, Holborn

A buzzy lobby with good wifi, walkable to Covent Garden and the British Museum. Camden David rates the Hoxton brand.

££ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [Camden David](#)

TOWER HILL • SOLO

citizenM Tower of London

Compact rooms beside the Tower and the river, on the District and Circle lines.

££ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Wiley Fox pick

Search all London hotels

Compare live prices, then check the street on the Wiley Fox map before you

book.

SEARCH BOOKING.COM

WF

Clip a Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child. If you get separated in a crowd, anyone who scans it can contact you straight away - no app needed on their side.

WHAT CREATORS RATE

Ten things worth your time

Many of London's best experiences are free. Book the free ones early, because they fill up.

The free museums

SOUTH KENSINGTON & BLOOMSBURY • GREAT FOR KIDS

01

The Natural History Museum, Science Museum, V&A and British Museum are free. Book a free time slot online to skip the queue.

Via [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Happy to Wander](#), [Destination Well Known](#), [Wolters World](#)

Free

DETAILS

02

Tower of London

TOWER HILL • GREAT FOR KIDS

Crown Jewels and Beefeater stories. The evening Ceremony of the Keys is a few pounds but sells out a month ahead.

Via [The Tour Guy](#), [Happy to Wander](#)

Paid

BOOK

Photo: Bob Collowan · [CC BY-SA 3.0](#)

Free sky-high views

THE CITY • GREAT FOR KIDS

03

Sky Garden and Horizon 22 are free but need booking in advance. Sky Garden is higher than the London Eye.

Via [Love and London](#), [Happy to Wander](#), [Destination Well Known](#), [Through My Lens](#)

Free, book ahead

DETAILS

04

Changing the Guard

BUCKINGHAM PALACE • GREAT FOR KIDS

Not every day - check the official schedule the week before. Arrive early and watch your bag in the crowd.

Via [Wolters World](#), [The Tour Guy](#)

Free

DETAILS

Photo: Carlos Delgado · [CC BY-SA 3.0](#)

05

Thames path: London Eye to Tower Bridge

Photo: Diego Delso · [CC BY-SA 4.0](#)

SOUTH BANK • GREAT FOR KIDS

The classic riverside walk past Tate Modern, Shakespeare's Globe and Borough Market.

Via [Suitcase Monkey](#), [Wolters World](#)

Free

BOOK

06

Greenwich & the Royal Observatory

GREENWICH • GREAT FOR KIDS

One of the best free city views, stand on the Prime Meridian, and arrive by river boat.

Via [TOPJAW](#), [Destination Well Known](#)

Free view

BOOK

07

Diana Memorial Playground

KENSINGTON GARDENS • GREAT FOR KIDS

A pirate-ship playground next to Kensington Palace - a favourite for under-12s.

Via [The Tour Guy](#)

Free

DETAILS

08

Regent's Canal walk

LITTLE VENICE TO KING'S CROSS • GREAT FOR KIDS

A traffic-free towpath through Camden. The Paddington to King's Cross stretch suits families.

Via [Suitcase Monkey](#), [Love and London](#)

Free

DETAILS

A West End show

COVENT GARDEN & SOHO • GREAT FOR KIDS

09

Enter ticket lotteries and check TodayTix for same-day deals. Skip the street touts.

Via [Happy to Wander](#), [Love and London](#)

From about £25

BOOK

Harry Potter Studio Tour

LEAVESDEN, OUTSIDE LONDON • GREAT FOR KIDS

10

About an hour north of London - book weeks ahead, it sells out.

Via [Destination Well Known](#), [The Tour Guy](#), [Happy to Wander](#)

Paid

BOOK

If you only have one day

ONE

1

The classic loop

- | | |
|-------|---|
| 09:00 | Westminster. Big Ben and Westminster Abbey, then walk to Buckingham Palace for Changing the Guard (check it's on). |
| 12:30 | Lunch. Regency Café for a proper fry-up, or pick up a meal deal for a picnic in St James's Park. |
| 14:00 | South Bank. Cross the river and walk the Thames path past Tate Modern to Borough Market. |
| 17:30 | Tower Bridge. Walk over Tower Bridge and on to the Tower of London at golden hour. |
| 19:30 | Dinner. Chinatown: Four Seasons for roast duck and Bun House for dessert. Keep phones away on the busy streets. |

Three days, grouped by area

DAY

1

Royal London

AM	Westminster, Buckingham Palace, St James's Park, then the Thames path to Borough Market.
PM	Tower of London and Tower Bridge.
EVE	Chinatown and a West End show.

DAY

2

Museums & parks

AM	Natural History Museum and V&A (free, book a slot).
PM	Kensington Gardens and the Diana Memorial Playground.
EVE	Dinner at Dishoom or Homeslice in Covent Garden.

DAY

3

River & views

AM	Uber Boat to Greenwich and the Royal Observatory.
PM	Sky Garden or Horizon 22 (pre-booked) and a Leadenhall Market wander.
EVE	Shoreditch for food; plan a cab or Safest Route home.

WITH TOPJAW

Where to eat

Restaurant picks lead with TOPJAW, who have interviewed more than 200 chefs about where they really eat. Every place is credited to the creator who recommended it.

Regency Café

WESTMINSTER • CLASSIC LONDON CAFÉ

£

A time-warp caff that has starred in films. A full breakfast for about the price of a sourdough loaf elsewhere - have your order ready.

Family friendly

Via TOPJAW

VISIT

Bun House

CHINATOWN • CANTONESE BUNS

£

Filled steamed buns - pork, veggie and a custard one that children love.

Family friendly

Via TOPJAW

VISIT

Four Seasons (Wardour Street)

CHINATOWN • CANTONESE ROAST MEATS

££

The place for roast duck and roast pork over rice.

Family friendly

Via TOPJAW

VISIT

Arcade Food Hall

TOTTENHAM COURT ROAD • FOOD HALL

££

Eight kitchens under one roof - easy when everyone wants something different. Upstairs, Plaza Khao Gaeng (Michelin-listed southern Thai) does one of London's best beef massaman curries.

Family friendly

Via TOPJAW

VISIT

Seashell of Lisson Grove

MARYLEBONE • FISH & CHIPS

££

A long-running chippy on TOPJAW's fish and chips list - near Regent's Park and Baker Street.

Family friendly

Via [TOPJAW](#)

VISIT

Dishoom

SEVERAL SITES INCL. COVENT GARDEN & KING'S CROSS • BOMBAY CAFÉ

££

The London Indian restaurant creators send everyone to. Expect a queue at peak times.

Family friendly

Via [Evan Edinger](#), [The Tour Guy](#)

VISIT

Homeslice

NEAL'S YARD, SEVEN DIALS • PIZZA

££

Giant shareable pizzas a few steps from Covent Garden - a better bet than Leicester Square chains.

Family friendly

Via [Evan Edinger](#)

VISIT

Beigel Bake

BRICK LANE • BAKERY, OPEN 24 HOURS

£

The salt beef bagel is a London rite of passage. A good daytime stop on a Brick Lane visit.

Family friendly

Via [Camden David](#)

VISIT

Crisp Pizza

HAMMERSMITH (W6) • PIZZA IN A PUB

££

TOPJAW's pick for London's best pizza. Book a couple of weeks ahead; they suggest the Picante and the hot-honey Vecna.

Grown-ups

Via **TOPJAW**

VISIT

Wingmans

SOHO & KILBURN • CHICKEN WINGS

££

Award-winning wings, casual and quick.

Family friendly

Via **TOPJAW**

VISIT

Pophams

LONDON FIELDS & ISLINGTON • BAKERY

£

Pastries baked on site all day. The order: a cardamom bun and a black americano.

Family friendly

Via **TOPJAW**

VISIT

Donia

KINGLY COURT, CARNABY • FILIPINO

££

Upstairs in Kingly Court. Try the ube choux for dessert.

Grown-ups

Via **TOPJAW**

VISIT

The Harwood Arms

FULHAM • SUNDAY ROAST

£££

Chefs' choice for a Sunday roast. Book well ahead.

Family friendly

Via **TOPJAW**

VISIT

For a grown-ups' night out, TOPJAW's chef interviews point to The Devonshire in Soho for a pint of Guinness and the Connaught Bar in Mayfair for a martini. Opening times and menus change, so check before you travel. Wiley Fox is not paid for restaurant listings.

BEFORE YOU GO

Getting around London

From the airport

Heathrow is on the Piccadilly and Elizabeth lines - tap your card and go. Creators rate the Heathrow Express as quick but poor value unless you are staying at Paddington. Check late-night options before booking a cheap arrival into Stansted or Luton; the last trains can leave you with an expensive taxi.

Via [Happy to Wander](#), [Love and London](#), [Wolters World](#), [Evan Edinger](#)

Pay with contactless

Tap the same card or phone in and out. Daily caps are applied automatically: £8.90 a day for zones 1-2 on Tube and rail, frozen until March 2027. Paper tickets and paper day Travelcards cost more.

Via [Love and London](#), [Evan Edinger](#), [The Tour Guy](#)

Buses

£1.75 a ride with unlimited changes within an hour (the Hopper fare). Routes 11 and 24 pass many of the big sights and make a cheap sightseeing tour from the top deck.

Via [Love and London](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Happy to Wander](#)

Children

Under-11s travel free on the Tube and buses with a paying adult. Avoid the Tube at 7:30-9am and 5-7pm with small children and pushchairs.

Via [Happy to Wander](#)

Taxis

Black cabs are licensed and heavily regulated - if the orange light is on, it's free. Free Now books licensed cabs by app and shows the fare estimate. Ignore unlicensed minicabs that approach you in the street.

Via [Love and London](#), [Happy to Wander](#), [Wolters World](#)

By river

The Uber Boat (Thames Clippers) is part of the public network - tap in and ride to Greenwich or the Tower. A relaxing option when little legs are tired.

Via [Destination Well Known](#), [Wolters World](#)

Walk more

Many central Tube stops are only 5-15 minutes apart on foot. Victoria to

Late at night

If you're on your own late, a licensed cab is worth the money over a long walk. Plan the

Buckingham Palace, for example, is faster walking. Stand on the right on escalators.

Via [Wolters World](#), Evan Edinger

route home before you head out - Wiley Fox's Safest Route helps.

Via [Love and London](#)

What it costs

Tube, zones 1-2, full day	£8.90 cap 2026
Bus ride (Hopper)	£1.75 2026
UK ETA (many visitors)	£20 Apr 2026
Supermarket meal deal (sandwich, snack, drink)	about £5 Nov 2024
Central 4-star hotel, no breakfast	about £270 a night Jan 2025
Pint in a central pub	about £7.50 May 2023 - check current price
Espresso at Algerian Coffee Stores, Soho	about £1.20 Apr 2024
Restaurant service charge	12.5% usually added 2025

Creator prices carry the video date. Anything older than 18 months is marked to check.

Quick tips

Look right

Traffic drives on the left. Wolters World has seen tourists hit stepping out the wrong way - follow the 'look right' markings.

Book the free stuff

Sky Garden, Horizon 22 and museum time slots are free but go fast. Book as soon as your dates are set.

Don't overload days

One or two paid sights a day, grouped by area. London rewards wandering.

Skip the 'awful four' combo

Love and London's name for pricey ticket bundles (Dungeon, Shrek, Aquarium, Madame Tussauds). Fine for small kids; poor value otherwise.

Keep kids out of phone boxes

The famous red boxes are often used as toilets. Photo outside, not in.

Tag the kids

A Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child means anyone who finds them can reach you in seconds.

WF

Seen something other travellers should know? Drop a community report on the map - it helps rate the area for the next family.

THE SMALL THINGS VISITORS WORRY ABOUT

Local tips for London

Every tip here was checked against an official or trusted source (TfL, National Rail, gov.uk, NHS, the Royal Parks and others) on the date shown. Rules and prices change, so tap the link to double-check before you travel.

Paying for transport

Can I pay for the Tube with my phone?

Yes – just tap Apple Pay, Google Pay or a contactless card on the yellow reader; no need to buy a ticket or Oyster card first.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Will I overpay if I travel a lot in one day?

No – pay as you go is capped daily and across the Monday–Sunday week, but only if you touch in and out with the same card or phone every time. Checked 2026-09 ↗

Why was I charged twice or the wrong fare?

Keep your other cards away from your phone when you tap – the reader can pick the wrong card ("card clash"), which breaks your cap. Checked 2026-09 ↗

Do I touch out on the bus?

No – on buses and trams you only touch in when you board. On the Tube and trains, always touch out too or you may be charged a maximum fare. Checked 2026-09 ↗

Will my overseas card cost extra on the Tube?

It might – TfL warns non-UK cards can carry overseas transaction fees, so use a fee-free travel card or check with your bank before you go. Checked 2026-09 ↗

Do my kids need a ticket on the Tube?

Up to four children under 11 travel free with a fare-paying adult on the Tube, DLR, Overground and Elizabeth line, and they're free on buses and trams too.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Is there a cheaper fare for my teenager?

Yes – 11–15-year-olds pay child rates; visitors can ask station staff to add the Young Visitor discount (half adult pay as you go, up to 14 days) to a Visitor Oyster card. From 16 it's adult fares.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

How do families save on UK train tickets?

A Family & Friends Railcard gives adults 1/3 off and kids 5–15 up to 60% off – at least one named adult and one child must travel together, and it works as a digital card in the app. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Is there a railcard for two adults travelling together?

The Two Together Railcard saves 1/3 on train fares for two named adults travelling together – worth it for couples or friends doing day trips out of London.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Can the kids ride a Santander hire bike?

Only an adult 18+ can hire, but they can authorise riders aged 14 and over under their hire – younger children can't ride them.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

How do I avoid stairs with a buggy or wheelchair?

Check the step-free symbols on the official Tube map before you set off – many central stations still have stairs only.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Water & snacks

Where do I get cheap water and snacks?

Skip the coffee shop and pop into a Tesco, Sainsbury's or Boots – their lunch meal deals (main, snack and drink for one price) are the best-value quick lunch in London.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Can I ask for free tap water in a pub or restaurant?

Yes – any premises licensed to serve alcohol on site must give free tap water on request where it's reasonably available, so just ask.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Where can I refill my water bottle for free?

Download the free Refill app – it maps cafés, shops and fountains that will top up your bottle at no charge. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Toilets

Where's the nearest toilet?

Use the free Great British Public Toilet Map (toiletmap.org.uk) – it shows the nearest public loos, including accessible and baby-change facilities. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Do I have to pay for toilets at stations?

No – toilets at London's National Rail stations are free, and TfL publishes a map of which Tube and rail stations have them.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Can I use a toilet without buying anything?

Museums and galleries usually have free loos, and in the City of London the Community Toilet Scheme lets you use toilets in participating shops, pubs and restaurants without buying.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Parks & play

Are London's playgrounds free?

Yes – the Royal Parks run 14 playgrounds, including Greenwich Park, Gloucester Gate in Regent's Park and Bushy Park, and they're free to use. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Can we get into the Diana Memorial Playground?

It's free for children up to 12 with a supervising adult, but it fills up fast on warm days – arrive at opening (10am) to avoid queues. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Where can we go on a rainy day without spending much?

The big museums – British Museum, Natural History Museum, Science Museum, V&A, National Gallery and Tate Modern – are free; book a free timed ticket online and note special exhibitions cost extra.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Money & tipping

Should I tip if there's a service charge on the bill?

No need to add more – a service charge is effectively the tip, and by law all tips and service charges must be passed on in full to staff. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Does a tip paid on card reach the staff?

Yes – since October 2024 employers must pass on 100% of tips, including card tips, to workers without deductions.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Phones & data

Will using my phone data in the UK cost a fortune?

Check your home network's roaming charges before you arrive and switch off data roaming if unsure – a local SIM or travel eSIM plus free Wi-Fi is often much cheaper. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

What should I note down in case my phone is stolen?

Dial *#06# to get your phone's IMEI number and write it down – police and your network use it to block and trace a stolen handset.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Safety habits

How do I stop my phone being snatched?

What if someone grabs my bag or phone?

Step back from the kerb and stand near a wall when using your phone, keep calls short and don't text while walking – thieves on bikes and mopeds target distracted people. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Let it go – the Met's advice is never to confront a thief; your safety matters more than the device. Set up a screen lock and remote wipe before your trip. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Which areas should I be extra alert in?

Before heading out, check the neighbourhood's safety score in the Wiley Fox app (www.thewileyfox.com) and pair it with the Met's phone-safety habits.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Which number do I call for help?

Call 999 in an emergency (112 also works from mobiles). For urgent but non-emergency medical help, use NHS 111 by phone or online at 111.nhs.uk – it's available 24/7. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Local ways

Which side of the escalator do I stand on?

Stand on the right and leave the left clear for people walking – it's one of the quickest ways to blend in on the Tube. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Travel with Wiley Fox

Live crime data for any UK street, Safest Route home, one-tap SOS, and QR wristbands so lost children and lost bags find their way back.

Our sources

This guide summarises these creators' videos in our own words. Watch the originals - they are worth it. Crime data: data.police.uk (May 2026 to Jul 2026), contains public sector information licensed under the Open Government Licence v3.0. Fares: Transport for London. ETA: UK Home Office.

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